

Standard Operating Procedure

Pressure-Ulcer Risk Assessment and Prevention

«Hospital Name» — Supports COP.16.c (Stop-Work)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» identifies patients at risk of developing a new pressure ulcer, or of an existing one worsening, and manages both scenarios.

2. Scope

Applies to every in-patient at admission and on any significant change in condition or mobility.

3. Responsibility

Admitting/Ward Nurse: completes the pressure-ulcer risk assessment and implements the resulting management plan.

4. Procedure

1. Assess every patient using the hospital's adopted validated tool (e.g. Braden Scale) at admission.
2. The assessment covers both risk scenarios separately: risk of developing a new pressure ulcer, and risk of an existing pressure ulcer worsening. Address both, not just one.
3. For patients found at risk, implement management per written guidance (e.g. repositioning schedule, pressure-relieving mattress, skin inspection frequency).
4. Reassess on any significant change in mobility, nutrition, or overall condition.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not use a non-validated or informal method as a substitute for the adopted pressure-ulcer risk tool.

Do not assess only for new-ulcer risk while ignoring worsening risk for a patient who already has one — both must be addressed.

Raising a missed or overdue assessment is not a disciplinary matter.

6. Records

Supported by Record 4 of the COP.16 Required Records pack: Pressure-Ulcer Risk Assessment Record.

7. Related Documents

- HCO_COP_16_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — COP.16 policy

8. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any hospital-acquired pressure ulcer of Stage 2 or higher.

9. References

- Bergstrom, N., Braden, B. J., Laguzza, A., & Holman, V. (1987). The Braden Scale for predicting pressure sore risk. *Nursing Research*, 36(4), 205-210. <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/3299278/> — the original validation of the Braden Scale, the hospital's adopted example tool.